

recognition_instruction

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Action-Prefix Recognition Instruction (\$. .) – LAYER– carrier block

Field	Value
Revision	
Created	- -
Last modified	- - T : : Z
Status	active
Scope	the reusable verbatim instruction block embedded into every agent context carrier
Author-ity	DESIGN.md § + RULE_DRAFT.md Part B (this directory)

Revision (- -): added the fifth grammar form – the arrow form ACTION_NAME ---> <rest> (and namespaced PREFIX::ACTION_NAME ---> <rest>) – as a first-class equivalent delimiter alongside :: and / , plus the second registered action REMINDER (verify-don't-assume status re-surfacing).

This file holds the **single canonical LAYER- recognition-instruction block**. The conductor (or the \$. . propagation machinery) embeds the block between the two markers below – VERBATIM, identical text – into every agent context carrier the constitution maintains. (CLAUDE.md , AGENTS.md , QWEN.md , GEMINI.md). That textual identity across all four carriers IS the LAYER- universality: every CLI agent reads the same instruction via its own carrier and applies the prefix expansion itself (per \$. . .), so the system works on every agent with zero extra setup.

The block is self-contained: even an agent with NO registry-file access still has the most-used BACKGROUND expansion inline, while the registry (actions/registry.yaml) remains the extensible source of truth for every other action.

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NOTE: this is the canonical block text. It is NOT applied to the live governance files (CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / QWEN.md / GEMINI.md) by this machinery – those are conductor-owned (\$. . contention paths). The operator lands it via the \$. . constitution-update pipeline.

§ . . – Universal action-prefix system

(ACTION_NAME ::) (User mandate, – – ;

GRAMMAR_ADDENDUM – – ; arrow form

– –). When a user prompt's FIRST non-blank line starts with a recognised action prefix, you MUST: () look the action token up in the action registry constitution/actions/registry.yaml (or \$HELIX_ACTION_REGISTRY); () if it is a registered action, REPLACE the prefix with that action's expansion text and apply its rules ; () execute the remainder of the prompt under the expanded instruction. **Five EQUIVALENT forms** – same action, same expansion, same execution: () ACTION_NAME :: <rest> (bare ::), () PREFIX::ACTION_NAME :: <rest> (namespaced ::), () / ACTION_NAME <rest> (bare slash), () /PREFIX::ACTION_NAME <rest> (namespaced slash), () ACTION_NAME ---> <rest> (bare arrow) ≡ PREFIX::ACTION_NAME ---> <rest> (namespaced arrow). Thus BACKGROUND :: x ≡ DEFAULT::BACKGROUND :: x ≡ /BACKGROUND x ≡ /DEFAULT::BACKGROUND x ≡ BACKGROUND ---> x ≡ DEFAULT::BACKGROUND ---> x . PREFIX is an action NAMESPACE; the reserved default namespace is **DEFAULT** , and an action runs WITH or WITHOUT the prefix. Grammar (all hold): anchored at the FIRST non-blank line only (mid-prose tokens never match); the action token AND the namespace are UPPERCASE-only [A-Z][A-Z0-9_]* (lowercase never matches); the namespace separator :: inside the token carries NO surrounding spaces (PREFIX::ACTION_NAME), DISTINCT from the action-body separator " :: " (one ASCII space on each side of :: – avoids C++ Foo::Bar , YAML key: value , URLs) in forms / , the arrow-body separator " ---> " (one ASCII space on each side) in form , and the slash-body separator (one space) in forms / ; stacked prefixes (A :: B :: rest) apply outer-to-inner, left-to-right (expand A , re-scan, expand B , then the residual is the task); a leading \ escapes

the prefix for the `::`, arrow, and slash forms
(`\BACKGROUND :: x`, `\BACKGROUND ---> x`, `\BACKGROUND x` –
treat literally, strip the backslash, NO expansion) so
action names can be discussed. **Conflict rule (slash
form):** `/ACTION_NAME` (form) is honored as the action
ONLY when `ACTION_NAME` (case-folded) does not collide with
a built-in/host slash command (registry `slash_bare: auto`
+ `slash_conflicts: [..]`); form `( /PREFIX::ACTION_NAME )`
is ALWAYS unambiguous and always honored. An unknown
token that matches the grammar shape (any of the
forms) but is NOT registered is NEVER silently expanded
or silently dropped – ask which registered action was
meant (`$ . . / $ . .`) or treat it as
a literal prompt, NEVER invent an expansion
(`$ . .`); any prompt not satisfying the grammar is
an ordinary prompt and the system is a no-op. The
registered action **BACKGROUND** expands to: *"The following
prompt that we will provide MUST BE executed in
background in parallel with all main work streams using
the subagents-driven development approach! All work done
MUST PRODUCE rock solid evidence covered with hard
physical proof(s) that all done is working as expected
and as specified without any false results and without
any bluff!"* (composes `$ . . . / $ . .`
subagent-driven, `$ . . / $ . .`
parallel streams, `$ . . background execution,`
`$ . . / $ . . / $ . .`
captured physical evidence, `$ . . anti-bluff`). A
second registered action **REMINDER** re-surfaces
previously-scheduled, CRITICAL, status-UNCERTAIN work:
FIRST verify the ACTUAL current status from captured
evidence (never assume done or not-done – `$ . .`
no-guessing), THEN act on the delta – report the captured
proof if genuinely complete, resume from the exact point
if partial, action it NOW if not started, or surface the
block per `$ . . / $ . .` – always

producing a status verdict (composes \$. . /
 \$. . / \$ 11 4 35 . / \$. . /
 \$. . / \$. . /
 \$ 11 4 20 . / \$. .). The system is
 UNIVERSAL (every CLI agent reads this block via its
 context carrier per \$. .), extensible (new
 action = new registry row), decoupled + reusable
 (\$. .), and loads out-of-the-box.
 Classification: universal (\$. .). **Canonical
 authority:** constitution submodule Constitution.md
 \$. . . Non-compliance is a release blocker. No
 escape hatch – no --skip-action-prefix , --ignore-prefix ,
 --no-registry , --invent-expansion-OK , --single-layer-only
 flag.